

Husqvarna Automower iQ Series Follow-up

Since the June 2 audit we re-pulled the BBB profile on the entity registered to husqvarna.com/us, added Amazon Rufus to the engine battery, re-tested every critical finding, and traced the “wired and dated” mislabeling to named sources. The corrected inputs move the numbers by hundredths. This brief has the updated evidence and a fixed Phase 1 scope.

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Re-checked live, June 11

CRITICAL An agent still cannot buy

The agent endpoints (/well-known/ucp, agent.json, ai-plugin.json) return 403. The product pages have no checkout: “Add To Cart” exists only as a script string next to “Not Available Online,” and “Buy Now” is financing copy. The price (\$2,599.99 / \$3,299.99 / \$4,299.99) appears only in the structured-data block, not in the visible text.

CRITICAL The quotable reputation numbers got worse

Trustpilot, read this morning: 1.4 of 5 across 872 reviews, 81% one-star, profile still unclaimed. Trustpilot's sidebar on that page advertises Mammotion (4.0, 2.6K reviews) and Navimow. A June 9 review reads “Bought 3 robot lawn mowers... all 3 died.”

BBB, re-pulled on the entity registered to husqvarna.com/us (Husqvarna Professional Products, Inc., Charlotte NC): A+ letter rating, 1.03 of 5 customer average across 58 reviews, 204 complaints in three years. The corrected entity reads slightly worse than the June 2 figures (1.04, 191).

HIGH Discontinued models still look live to a machine

The 430X URL now redirects to a support page marked discontinued, but that page still serves a Product schema node, and the 450X and 450XH URLs still return 200. This is why engines answer brand queries with the wrong, costlier model, and why the 430X shows up in Rufus results.

HIGH The pages don't answer the question buyers actually ask

The top objection in the third-party corpus is satellite dropout under trees. The product pages say nothing about trees or canopy, in the text or in any of the nine structured FAQs, even though the iQ's wire fallback answers it directly. The offer markup also omits GTIN, rating, reviews, shipping, returns and seller, and the description field is empty.

STRENGTH Access is clean and recent fixes are real

Every AI crawler we tested gets a byte-identical page. The pages now carry FAQ schema that opens with the wire-free answer, captioned imagery and video markup, all server-rendered. The remaining work is specific and small; Phase 1 specifies it.

Amazon Rufus, first battery

Four buying prompts, run by hand on June 11 (Amazon allows no automated access; screenshots on file).

PROMPT	HUSQVARNA PLACEMENT	RATING SHOWN	ANSWER WON BY
Best robotic mower 2026	Present, in the “trusted brand, premium budget” slot (410iQ)	4.0★ (45)	ECOVACS / Mammotion / Navimow
Large yard	440iQ listed first on coverage	3.5★ (22)	Mammotion, “great reviews (4.4★)”
Two acres	Top pick: 440iQ, “only option rated for 2 acres”	3.5★ (22)	Husqvarna
Tree-heavy yard	In the premium bucket, out of the top picks	4.0/4.1★	ANTHBOT / ECOVACS

Rufus reads Amazon's catalog, and it gets the iQ right: wire-free in every answer, with the 430X correctly flagged as the wired one. The open-web engines read the third-party corpus and call the same products wired. That contrast localizes the problem. The product data is fine; the corpus is not.

Where Rufus stated a preference, it priced reviews: best overall went to Mammotion at 4.4★/87 against the 440iQ's 3.5★/22. An analysis of 1,300+ Rufus recommendations (Amalytix) found it almost never recommends below 4.0★, and its median pick has 4.5★ and about 3,000 reviews. The 440iQ won the two-acre slot on spec coverage alone, which holds only until a competitor ships a 2-acre model. Amazon listings also run \$38 over the brand site on the 410 and 420, a third-party seller signature.

Where “wired and dated” comes from

We swept 18 ranking pages, the comparison sites, Reddit and YouTube. The pattern: major publishers are still testing 2022 wired models, and the best-ranked wire-free content is written by competitors. Engines repeat what they can retrieve.

SOURCE	UPDATED	WHAT IT TELLS AN ENGINE
PCWorld	Sep 2025	Husqvarna (435X) “depends on a boundary wire”; no iQ
Reviewed (USA Today)	May 2026	Brand absent; used as the boundary-wire example
SlashGear	Jun 9, 2026	Husqvarna “requires boundary wire setup”; Segway #1
Lawn Love	May 2026	Wire install “a notable limitation”
BBC Gardeners' World	Apr 2026	Reviews the wired 308V; EPOS treated as an add-on
Mammotion's own blog	Mar 2026	Ranks #1 in Google for “best robot lawn mower 2026”; Husqvarna absent
“Luba vs Husqvarna” sites (4)	2024-25	All four say “requires boundary wires”; none mention the iQ
r/automower threads	2024-25	“EPOS loses satellites under trees,” with no reply from anyone
YouTube 2026 roundups	2026	40-135K views each, no iQ; the one iQ video has 11K views

Only 4 of the 18 ranking pages mention the iQ at all, all small blogs, and those are the amplification targets. Why this matters: 43.8% of the pages ChatGPT cites on “best X” questions are exactly these lists, 79% updated within a year (Ahrefs, 26K cited URLs), and YouTube mentions are the strongest measured correlate of AI visibility ($r \approx 0.74$, Ahrefs, 75K brands). ChatGPT's citations track Bing, not Google, and about 90% of what it cites sits past position 20 in Google, so existing SEO work doesn't transfer.

Phase 1: \$1,000 fixed, two to three weeks

What Blackwell delivers. Acceptance criteria attach here.

- A patch spec for each iQ page: ready-to-paste structured data (rating from the real ~4.0 retailer reviews, GTIN, description, shipping, returns, seller), the validator fix list, FAQ copy answering the under-trees objection, and a visible-price recommendation.
- A retirement spec for the discontinued models: strip their Product schema, date the pages, point to the iQ successors.
- The correction dossier: every source in the table above with the offending sentence quoted, publisher contacts, drafted outreach letters, the YouTube seeding list, the amplification list.
- A reputation playbook: Trustpilot claim walkthrough with response templates, a BBB response track, and an Amazon review-program spec aimed at Rufus's observed floor.
- The re-benchmark: the six-engine battery plus Rufus, graded against the frozen June 2 truth table, delivered as a before/after deck.

What Husqvarna executes. CMS changes (we have no access to your properties), claiming the Trustpilot profile (verification runs through your domain), sending outreach and review units (your inventory, your channels), and Amazon listing work (your vendor account). We prepare all of it; your team ships it.

What nobody can promise. Whether PCWorld updates an article, whether a channel publishes a review, whether Reddit sentiment moves. We measure whether it happened. We don't sell that it will. That is why the re-benchmark is the deliverable: it shows what moved regardless of who moved it, and if a lever turns out to be dead, you'll know that too.

Score-movement expectations assume the specs ship before the re-test date. Public Goods ran this same structure after their audit.

Next step. \$1,000 fixed, scope above, specs and dossier delivered in week one, re-benchmark closes the engagement. We can start this week.

Method note. Re-verification performed June 11, 2026: direct fetches of the three iQ product pages under six user agents with structured-data extraction; agent-endpoint checks; BBB pull on the entity registered to husqvarna.com/us; live Trustpilot read; four-prompt Rufus battery run manually with screenshots retained; source sweep across 18 ranking pages, comparison sites, Reddit (via mirror; dates approximate) and YouTube (view counts via public API). All grading references the truth table frozen from husqvarna.com on June 2, 2026.